

thinking about regifting. But be careful; there are rules to follow.

Some people see a big stigma attached to regifting. Personally, I think it's fine if you follow a few simple guidelines. You don't want to hurt the feelings of the person who gave you the gift, or the person who gets the regifted item. But look at the alternatives: You can just let the offending item rot in your basement or garage; you can give it to charity; or you can put it out with the trash. So if you know someone who would really like the gift that just didn't do it for you, where's the harm?

I've combined my own rules with some research I did online and at my local library (yes, there are books and news stories on this—I kid you not). Generally, there seem to be some major guidelines that regifters follow to ensure everyone is happy. Here's what I have uncovered.



1. Don't let anyone know this is a regift.

It's amazing how often people have made it quite clear that I was receiving

a gift that was from their reject pile. Sure, they dressed it up nice enough, with language like "I just would never have used this cool gadget but I know how much you need one." It still makes you feel like you're getting crappy old hand-me-downs. Of course, if someone's giving me a brand-new, state-of-the-art laptop or cool pair of sunglasses, my hurt feelings fly out the window. But if it's a nasty crystal picture frame or a hideous painting, I'd rather not know you hated it as well. Ignorance is bliss.

2. If you get an unwanted gift that is meant for display, do the right thing first.

As much as you don't want to put that chintzy glass clown or fiber-optic lamp on display in your lovely abode, you may have to bite the bullet for a few weeks. The person who gave it to you will like to see it on display the next time they come over; otherwise they'll instantly know that you were lying when you said "It was just fabulous." So put it out on a hutch, coffee table, or kitchen counter for a while. But keep the box, if it has one, and all the accompanying packaging and tags. Once your gift-giver has seen the item on display, they feel appreciated. Then when it disappears from view, you can make up an appropriate